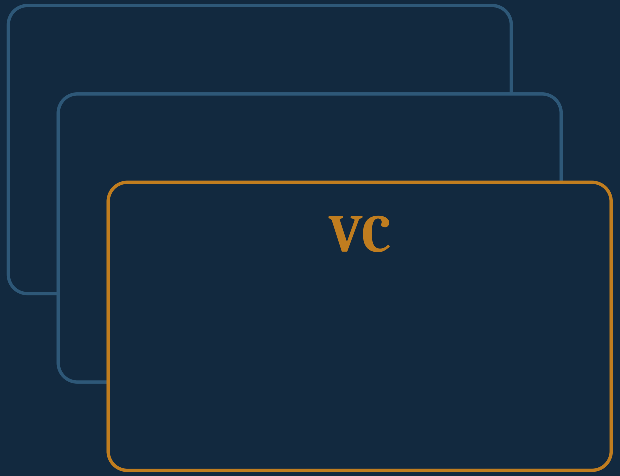
Business Wallets Secured by Verifiable Credentials

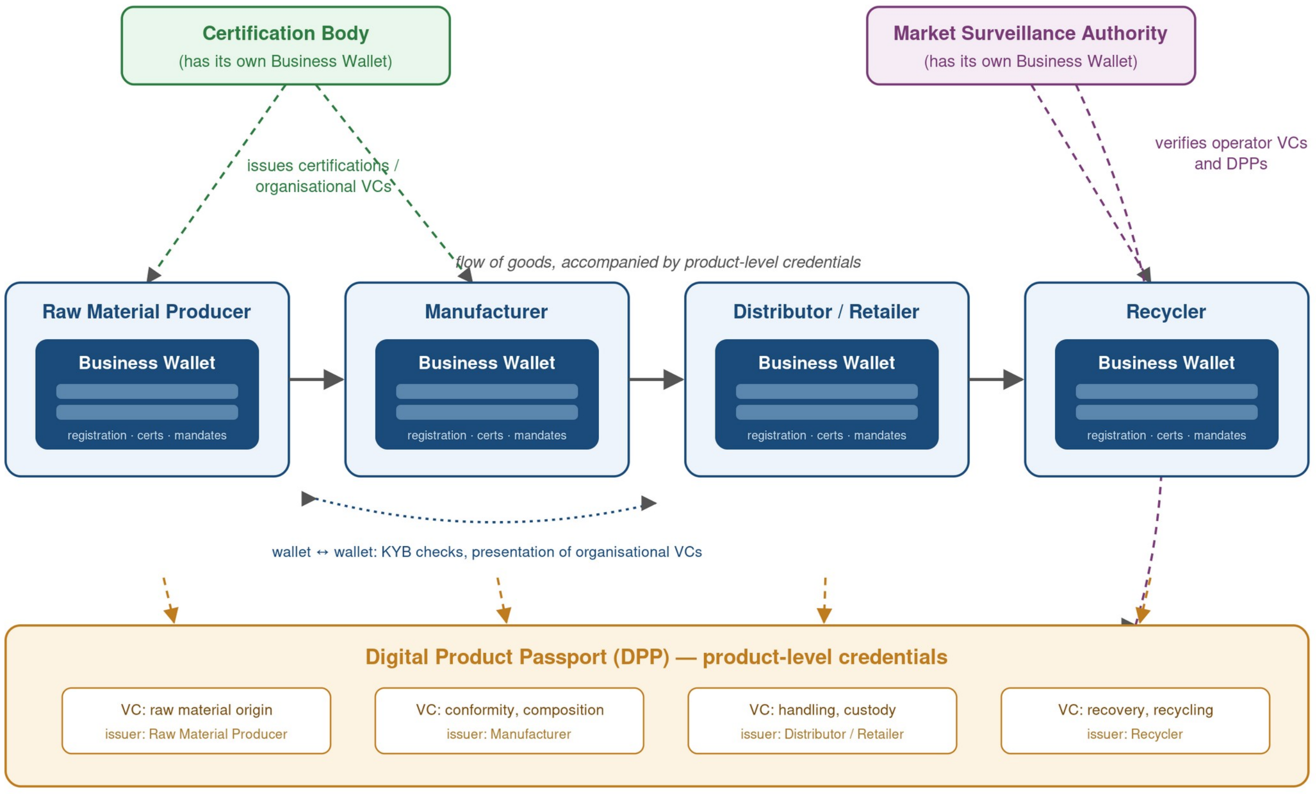


W3C Verifiable Credentials Working Group

DPP & Business Wallet Task Force

Editor's Draft — summary · July 2026

Every actor in the chain needs its own wallet



Every actor in the value chain — including certification bodies and authorities — operates its own Business Wallet to issue, hold, present and verify credentials.

A Business Wallet plays all four VC roles at once

1

Issues

invoices, DoCs,
DPPs, mandates

2

Holds

credentials about
the organisation

3

Presents

to counterparties
and authorities

4

Verifies

KYB checks on
a new supplier

A personal wallet mostly holds and presents.

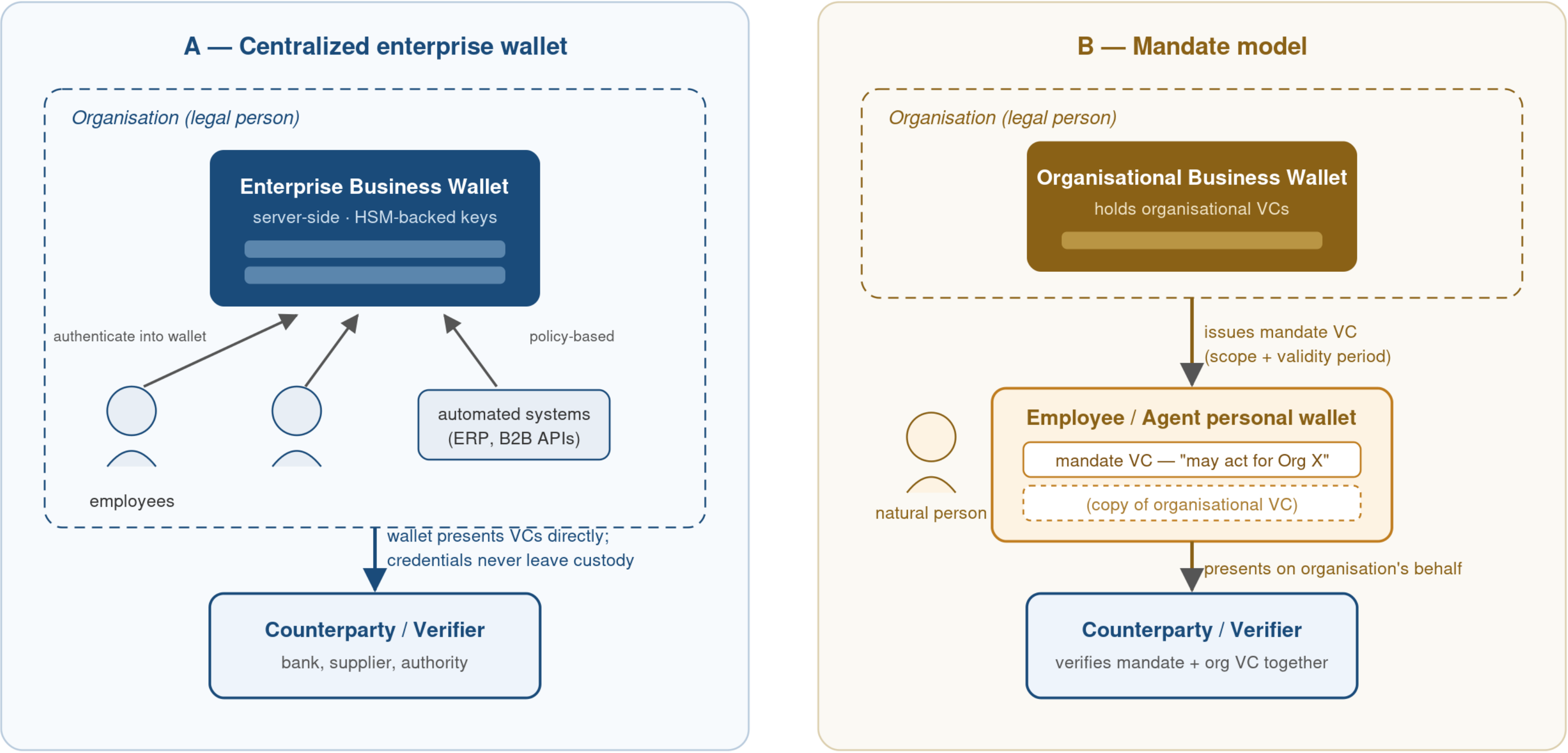
This asymmetry drives almost every requirement specific to Business Wallets.

Personal-wallet assumptions do not transfer

- **Keys outlive employees** — HSM custody, rotation without invalidating issued credentials
- **Headless operation** — no human tapping “share” — policy-based disclosure instead
- **Many users, one wallet** — who may issue, who may present what, and to whom
- **Companies merge; products don't** — what happens to credentials of the predecessor entity?
- **Liability and audit** — an out-of-scope mandate is presented — who is liable?

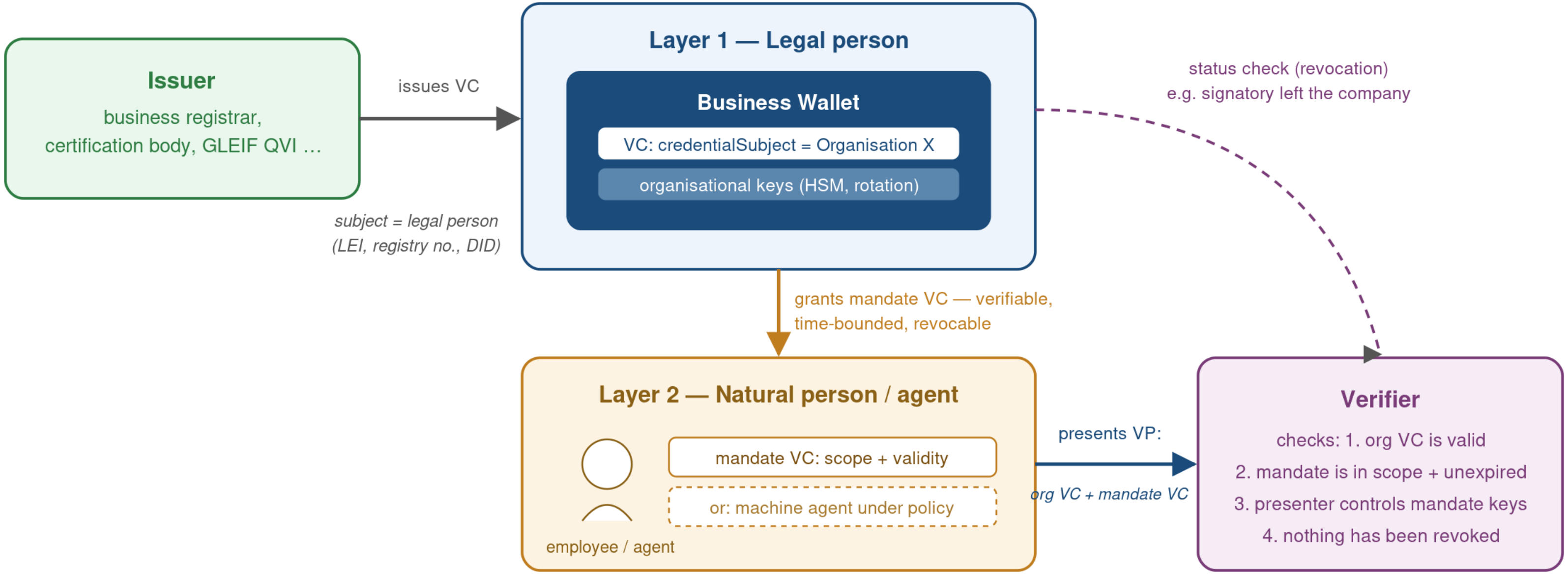
None of these has a counterpart in the natural-person or product wallet story.

One architectural choice comes first



Hybrid deployments combine both models. The choice determines holder binding, key management, and offboarding when an employee leaves.

Holder binding is layered, not one-to-one



The credential subject is the legal person, but every act of holding or presenting is performed by a natural person or machine agent whose authority must itself be verifiable.

What VCs add beyond a signed document

Baseline, from any digital signature: authenticity · integrity · non-repudiation

Standard data model	a verifier parses an unfamiliar registry's credential
Selective disclosure	reveal claims, not whole documents
Standardised revocation	status without a bilateral integration per issuer
Composable delegation	a mandate links to the credential it derives from
Data sovereignty	credentials sit in the org's wallet, not a platform

Redacting a signed PDF destroys its signature. Redacting a VC need not.

What the task force must settle

1. **Canonical credential subject** — LEI, national registry number, D-U-N-S, or DID?
2. **vLEI is built on ACDC and KERI** — map onto VCDM, or bridge to it?
3. **No shared vocabulary** — for organisation, authorisation and mandate credentials
4. **Bootstrapping issuer trust** — who vouches for the first credential in a chain?
5. **No requirements yet** — a UCR note needs numbered, testable requirements

w3c.github.io/vc-dpp-bw/bw-ucr/